

Week 5 Day 2 — HYBRID SEARCH (Your Code Integration)

BLOCK 1 — DSA Concept (VERY IMPORTANT)

Problem you just saw yesterday

From your screenshot:

 Linked list → correct

 BST vs AVL → failed

 Heap → failed

WHY?

 Your system currently does: Chroma search (semantic only)

 But real questions need: Keyword matching + concept understanding

Solution: Merge results

You will now have:

BM25 → exact keywords

Chroma → semantic meaning

 Then combine them intelligently

 Technique: Reciprocal Rank Fusion (RRF): $\text{score} = 1 / (\text{rank} + k)$

Example

Chunk	BM25 rank	Chroma rank
A	1	3
B	2	2

 Compute:

A → 1/61 + 1/63

B → 1/62 + 1/62

👉 B wins ✅ (more consistent)

🧠 BLOCK 2 — AI Concept

✅ Replace your current retrieval

Current:

```
def retrieve_context():
```

chroma only ❌

✅ New flow

User query

↓

BM25 search ✅

Chroma search ✅

↓

Merge (RRF) ✅

↓

Top 3 chunks

✅ Why this fixes your issues

Problem (Yesterday)	Fix
BST vs AVL	BM25 finds "AVL"
Heap	BM25 finds "heap insertion"
generic queries	Chroma still helps

🔥 BLOCK 3 — BUILD (update YOUR code)

✅ STEP 1 — Add RRF function

Put somewhere global:

```
def reciprocal_rank_fusion(bm25_chunks, chroma_chunks, k=60):  
    scores = {}  
    for rank, chunk in enumerate(bm25_chunks):  
        scores[chunk] = scores.get(chunk, 0) + 1 / (rank + k)  
    for rank, chunk in enumerate(chroma_chunks):  
        scores[chunk] = scores.get(chunk, 0) + 1 / (rank + k)  
    # sort by highest score  
    return sorted(scores, key=scores.get, reverse=True)
```

✅ STEP 2 — Modify YOUR `retrive_context()`

Replace your function:

```
def retrive_context(self, user_text):  
    # ✅ 1. Semantic search  
    embedded_user = self.embed(user_text)  
    chroma_chunks = self.loader.top_3_chunks(embedded_user)  
    # ✅ 2. BM25 search  
    bm25_chunks = self.loader.bm25.search(user_text, top_k=3)  
    print("BM25:", bm25_chunks)  
    print("CHROMA:", chroma_chunks)  
    # ✅ 3. Merge using RRF  
    merged = reciprocal_rank_fusion(bm25_chunks, chroma_chunks)  
    # ✅ 4. Take top 3  
    top_chunks = merged[:3]
```

```
if not top_chunks:
    return "No Context Found"

combined = " ".join(top_chunks)

# ✅ Quality gate

if len(combined.split()) < 15:
    return "No Context Found"

return "\n\n".join(top_chunks)
```

✅ STEP 3 — run test

Try same questions:

1. explain how deletion works in singly linked list
 2. difference between BST and AVL
 3. explain heap insertion
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✅ EXPECTED RESULT

✅ BEFORE

Q2 → ❌ no context

Q3 → ❌ wrong context

✅ AFTER

Q2 → ✅ BST + AVL chunks combined

Q3 → ✅ heap insertion chunk captured

🧠 KEY LEARNING

- ✅ BM25 → precision
 - ✅ Chroma → understanding
 - ✅ RRF → best of both
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🔥 DEBUG TIP (IMPORTANT)

Watch this:

BM25: [...]

CHROMA: [...]

MERGED: [...]

👉 You'll SEE how system improves

✅ VERIFICATION CHECKLIST

Make sure:

- ✅ Both BM25 + Chroma called
 - ✅ RRF merges results
 - ✅ top 3 chunks returned
 - ✅ BST vs AVL now answers correctly
 - ✅ heap question works
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🎯 REFLECTION (think now)

1. Chunk appears in both BM25 & Chroma
 - 👉 Does it rank higher? ✅ YES (boosted score)
 2. Latency
 - 👉 Slightly slower (2 searches instead of 1)
 3. Accuracy
 - 👉 MUCH higher ✅
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🚀 YOU JUST LEVELED UP

Yesterday: ❌ retrieval errors

Today: ✅ production-level hybrid RAG